GOVERNMENT OF INDIA

Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry & Dairying

Strengthening Rural Prosperity Through Sustainable Livelihoods

Confidential and Proprietory
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SHRI NARENDRA MODI

HONORABLE PRIME MINISTER, INDIA



MESSAGE

SHRI RAJIV RANJAN SINGH



HONORABLE MINISTER, MINISTRY OF FISHERIES, ANIMAL HUSBANDRY AND DAIRYING

MESSAGE

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MESSAGE

The fisheries, animal husbandry, and dairy sectors play a vital role in strengthening rural livelihoods, ensuring nutritional security, promoting exports, generating employment, and supporting inclusive economic development. The Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry and Dairying continues to lead transformative initiatives aimed at modernizing these sectors through innovation, infrastructure development, scientific practices, and sustainable resource management.

The Chamber of Commerce and Industries of India (CCI India) recognizes the immense potential of these sectors in driving rural entrepreneurship, value addition, food processing, export growth, and livelihood enhancement. Through policy advocacy, investment facilitation, industry partnerships, technology adoption, startup promotion, skill development, and market linkages, CCI India remains committed to supporting the Ministry's vision of creating a resilient and globally competitive livestock and fisheries ecosystem.

This Knowledge Paper provides comprehensive insights into the Ministry's strategic priorities, flagship programmes, policy initiatives, investment opportunities, and emerging trends across fisheries, dairy, animal health, breeding, aquaculture, cold chain infrastructure, veterinary services, and allied industries. It identifies collaborative opportunities that can enhance productivity, sustainability, and market competitiveness.

As India continues to unlock the full potential of its blue economy and livestock sectors, strategic partnerships will remain instrumental in achieving long-term growth and rural prosperity. CCI India remains committed to working alongside the Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry and Dairying in building a sustainable, technology-driven, and globally competitive ecosystem.

Munindra Kumar
Director General
CCI India

Preface

The Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry and Dairying occupies a pivotal position in India's governance architecture, overseeing the livestock, dairy, and fisheries sectors that support millions of rural livelihoods while remaining among the fastest-growing segments of the agricultural economy. As India advances towards the vision of *Viksit Bharat 2047*, these sectors are central to strengthening nutrition security, enhancing export competitiveness, and driving inclusive rural income growth, particularly for women and smallholder farmers.

Over the past decade, the sectors have recorded significant progress. Milk production has exceeded 247 million tonnes, fish production has more than doubled since 2013–14 to over 197 lakh tonnes, and seafood exports now exceed ₹62,000 crore. However, challenges remain in cold-chain infrastructure, value addition, veterinary and biosecurity systems, and mobilising private investment. Addressing these gaps requires stronger implementation capacity, market linkages, and institutional partnerships.

This Knowledge Paper provides the Ministry, NITI Aayog, and other stakeholders with a data-driven assessment of the current status of the livestock, dairy, and fisheries sectors, identifies key opportunities and constraints, and outlines practical recommendations for accelerating sustainable growth. It is designed as a policy advisory document, focusing on evidence-based analysis and actionable solutions.

The Chamber of Commerce and Industry of India (CCI India) proposes to complement the Ministry's efforts by serving as a structured industry partner. Through its nationwide network, investor engagement, and policy expertise, CCI India can facilitate public-private investment, support flagship government initiatives, strengthen the agri-tech and aqua-tech ecosystem, and promote global best practices across the value chain.

Prepared for policymakers, senior government officials, industry leaders, investors, development finance institutions, and multilateral agencies, this paper aims to foster a collaborative approach between government and industry in building a resilient, globally competitive, and inclusive livestock, dairy, and fisheries economy by 2047.

Chamber of Commerce and Industry (CCI India)

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About CCI India

CCI India (The Chamber of Commerce and Industry of India) is a premier national business chamber dedicated to fostering economic growth, industry development, entrepreneurship, innovation, and investment promotion across India. As the voice of Indian business and industry, CCI India serves as a bridge between government, industry, startups, academia, investors, and civil society, facilitating meaningful collaboration for nation-building and sustainable development.

Through policy advocacy, business facilitation, research, stakeholder engagement, capacity building, and strategic partnerships, CCI India works to create an enabling environment for enterprises of all sizes. The Chamber actively supports key national initiatives such as Startup India, Make in India, Digital India, Atmanirbhar Bharat, Skill India, and Viksit Bharat 2047 by connecting innovative enterprises with government opportunities and promoting inclusive economic development.

CCI India operates through sector-specific councils, industry forums, knowledge platforms, and state-level engagements that address emerging opportunities and challenges across sectors including manufacturing, agriculture, technology, healthcare, education, infrastructure, sustainability, MSMEs, and startups. The Chamber regularly organizes policy dialogues, investment summits, business delegations, workshops, conferences, and knowledge-sharing initiatives to strengthen India's economic ecosystem.

With a strong commitment to innovation, entrepreneurship, and public-private collaboration, CCI India strives to empower enterprises, facilitate investment, enhance competitiveness, and contribute to India's journey toward becoming a globally competitive and economically resilient nation. Its role as a knowledge partner and industry catalyst enables ministries, departments, state governments, startups, and businesses to collaborate effectively in achieving national development objectives.

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1: Introduction to the Ministry

1.1 Mandate and Rationale for a Dedicated Ministry

The Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry and Dairying (MoFAHD) was carved out as an independent Union Ministry in May 2019, elevating what had previously been a department within the Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare into a full ministerial portfolio. The decision reflected a deliberate policy judgment: that livestock, dairying, and fisheries had each grown large and complex enough economically, institutionally, and in terms of distinct regulatory needs to require dedicated ministerial attention rather than being administered as a subordinate function of crop agriculture. This elevation is itself a strategically significant signal, because it indicates that the sectors under this Ministry's charge are no longer viewed by the Union Government as ancillary to agriculture, but as a distinct pillar of the rural economy with its own investment, trade, and technology agenda.

- **Bifurcated Departmental Architecture:** The Ministry operates through two departments the Department of Animal Husbandry and Dairying (DAHD), tracing its institutional lineage to 1991, and the Department of Fisheries (DoF), formally constituted in February 2019. This bifurcation allows each department to pursue sector-specific scheme architecture, budget lines, and regulatory frameworks, while the Ministry provides unified political and administrative leadership. For CCI India, this structure means that any collaboration framework must be designed with department-specific work-streams rather than a single undifferentiated engagement, since procurement cycles, scheme guidelines, and approval authorities differ materially between DAHD and DoF.

- **Constitutional and Legislative Anchoring:** The Ministry's mandate draws on Entry 15 (preservation, protection and improvement of stock) of the State List and several Union and Concurrent List entries relating to inter-state trade in livestock products, fisheries beyond territorial waters, and standards for food articles, read together with Article 48 of the Constitution, which directs the State to take steps for preserving and improving breeds of livestock. In practice, this creates a layered federal structure in which the Centre sets national missions, standards, and co-funding architecture, while States retain primary implementation responsibility a structure that materially shapes how any industry partner, including CCI India, must engage simultaneously at the Union and State levels to achieve ground-level impact.

- **Governance Role as Nutritional and Livelihood Security Anchor:** Beyond its regulatory functions, the Ministry functions as the principal Union-level institution responsible for the nutritional security contribution of animal-source foods milk, eggs, and fish and for the livelihood security of an estimated 8 crore dairy farming households and nearly 3 crore people dependent on fisheries and aquaculture. This dual nutritional-and-livelihood mandate distinguishes the Ministry from purely commodity-trade-focused departments and gives its programmes a welfare dimension that is central to how schemes are designed, funded, and evaluated.

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